

Subscriptions on Galaxy Tab

Close on the heels of Conde Nast announcing magazine subscription on Apple iPad, Next Issue Media has similar plans for Samsung Galaxy Tab owners

Glasses-free 3D display

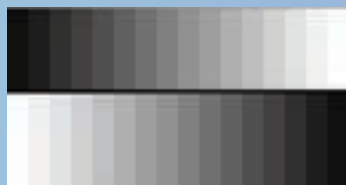
Toshiba unveiled an 8-inch glasses-free 3D display at SID 2011 in Los Angeles

LCD Monitor test

HOW WE TESTED

We divided the monitors received into categories based on their screen sizes. As far as features went, we logged all the physical specifications on the monitors including details of the panel, connectivity options, swivelling options, USB ports, etc. Build Quality was evaluated and scored accordingly. We also evaluated the on-screen display options and their ease of use.

Our test bed comprised an Intel Core i5-2500K processor at 3.3 GHz, with 2 GB of DDR3 RAM at 1333MHz and an AMD HD6850 graphics card. We used Spyder3Elite (seen alongside) to calibrate each display and also to give us the real contrast ratio and luminance value. Manufacturer's specified contrast ratios are determined under certain conditions and at specific brightness and contrast levels. While the luminance is calculated at 100 per cent brightness, we noticed that it was not the correct level for calculating contrast ratio, as some monitors showed heavy backlight bleeding on maximum brightness. Thus, to calculate contrast ratio with the Spyder3Elite colorimeter, we calculated contrast ratios with brightness levels at 100 per cent, 50 per cent and 0 per cent. An average of the three was taken to come up with the actual contrast ratio.



The calibrated monitors (at 50 per cent brightness level) were then subjected to a battery of



DisplayMate tests. This basically involves checking the grey scale intensity and visibility of grey squares of varying intensity on a black background.

DisplayMate's colour test suite allowed us to check for colour gamut and shade intensity rendition for each display. In the colour spectrum test (seen below), we look for the wideness of the gamut where the primary colours are separated by secondary colours and the entire spectrum is shown on-screen. Ideally, colours should smoothly merge into others without any vertical lines called banding. The 16-shade ramp test (bottom left) is used to calculate the transition from black to white, and any tinging of colours in this results in a lower score for the particular display. We check for uniformity of change in intensity and adequate separation between each band – this

tells us that the monitor is able to display variable intensities of a particular shade well.

Our movie test comprised a set of three 1080p clips which encompassed a mix of natural scenery, fast moving action scenes and scenes involving humans. We looked for the colour rendition, skin tones, noise and contrast levels. We used Resident Evil 5 and FarCry 2 to check detail, contrast and brightness in games.

Viewing angles were also evaluated for text, movie and game display.





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Bangalore Office: (M) +91 9900927702 iOffice 080 41696491



DEVRAJ COMPUTERS
+91 9381025354
+91 44 28548622 42156101 / 102

www.antec.com • international@antec.com



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